The Dhāraṇī of the Noble Parṇaśabarī

Āryaparṇaśabarīdhāraṇī · Toh 995 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་མ་རི་ཁྲོད་ལོ་མ་གྱོན་མའི་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī of the Noble Lady Parṇaśabarī, the Leaf-Clad Mountain Woman, known in Sanskrit as the Āryaparṇaśabarīdhāraṇī, is a short protective incantation addressed to the goddess Parṇaśabarī. Its Tibetan title describes her the same way, as the noble lady clad in leaves. The text opens with homages to the Three Jewels, to the Buddha Amitābha, and to the bodhisattvas Avalokiteśvara and Mahāsthāmaprāpta. It then invokes Parṇaśabarī herself, a forest-dwelling goddess who holds a noose and an axe and is also called the Dwarf Woman and Piśācī, and calls on her to dispel fears, epidemic diseases, and every kind of deadly harm and disturbance. It is Toh 995 in the Kangyur and belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the incantations recited for protection and healing that the Tibetan canon gathers into its dedicated dhāraṇī collections.

In the language of India: āryaparṇṇaśabaridhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī of the Noble Lady Parṇaśabarī, the Leaf-Clad Mountain Woman.

Homage to the Three Jewels!

Homage to the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Amitābha!

Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being, endowed with great compassion, the noble Avalokiteśvara!

Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being Mahāsthāmaprāpta!

Homage to you, the Dwarf!

Blessed Lady, Piśācī, Dwarf Woman Piśācī, Leaf-Clad Mountain Woman Piśācī, homage to you!

You who hold a noose and an axe in your hands: whatever fears may arise, all of them; whatever epidemic diseases there may be; whatever bringers of death there may be; whatever great bringers of death there may be; whatever harms there may be; whatever disturbances there may be; whatever inner afflictions there may be, all of them; contagious diseases; and whatever is connected with contagion, all of these arise only among the childish, and not in the wise. By this truth and by this word of truth, go away! Go away! And by these foundations of secret mantra blessed by the wise, protect! Protect! Bring about complete protection, complete protection, complete holding, pacification and well-being, the averting of punishment, the warding off of weapons, the neutralizing of poison, the destroying of poison, the setting of boundaries, and the binding of the ground!

tadyathā oṃ amṛte āśvaste āśvastadge māmara māmara praśama ubaśama dunnu pidunnu dule dumale svāhā nama sarbaśabarāṇāṃ namo mahāśaparāṇāṃ oṃ biśāci barṇṇaśabari biśāce svāhā oṃ parṇṇaśabari hūṃ phaṭ svāhā oṃ aṃkure maṃkure parṇṇaśabariye svāhā oṃ biśāci parṇṇaśabari sarbamāripraśamani sarbaduṣṭhānāna bandhamukhe sarbamukhe hūṃ phaṭ svāhā

The Dhāraṇī of the Noble Lady Parṇaśabarī, the Leaf-Clad Mountain Woman, is complete.

Translator's Notes

- "Dwarf" renders the Tibetan for "little short person," applied here as an epithet of the goddess. Its Sanskrit original is uncertain, so it is translated by its meaning. In the list of protections, the term the glossary gives as "annihilation" plainly means "punishment" in this protective formula ("the averting of punishment"), and it is rendered that way. In "the warding off of weapons," the Tibetan has "hostile toward" (sdang ba), which is probably a scribal variant of "averting" (spang ba). It is rendered in the averting sense.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.